

Koustuv Saha

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EDUCATION

- 2021–2025 **Ph.D. Agricultural Economics**, Purdue University, Indiana, USA
Dissertation: *Essays on Women's Work and Agency in Agriculture*
Advisors: Dr. Kajal Gulati, Dr. Jacob Ricker-Gilbert
- 2017–2019 **M.Phil. Development Studies**, Indira Gandhi Institute of Development Research, Mumbai, India
- 2014–2016 **M.Sc. Economics**, University of Calcutta, India
- 2011–2014 **B.Sc. Economics**, University of Calcutta, India

WORK EXPERIENCE

- Postdoctoral Researcher**, American University of Sharjah 2025–Present
- Graduate Research Assistant**, Purdue University 2021–2025
- Research Associate**, Indira Gandhi Institute of Development Research 2017–2020

AWARDS

- Uma Lele Prize for Best Contributed Paper on Gender, International Conference for Agricultural Economics, 2024. *For paper titled "Women's Work and Agricultural Productivity Gaps in India".*
- Ludwig Kruhe Fellowship, Purdue University (USD 68,766), 2024. *Awarded to the most outstanding graduate students across seven departments.*
- UGC Junior Research Fellowship, Government of India, 2017. *Awarded to top 6% of candidates nationally.*

PUBLICATIONS

- Gulati, K., **Saha, K.**, & Lybbert, T.J. (2025). "Women's Work and Agricultural Productivity Gaps in India." *American Journal of Agricultural Economics*. doi.org/10.1111/ajae.12536 *Awarded Uma Lele Prize for Best Paper.*
- Saha, K.**, Pandey, V.L., & Dev, S.M. (2023). "Women's Land Ownership and Household Decisions: Implications for Child Health in Rural India." In *Axes of Sustainable Development and Growth in India*. Springer Nature. doi.org/10.1007/978-981-19-9756-3_8

JOB MARKET PAPER

Strategy and Coordination in Risky Household Decisions

Abstract: A large share of an economy's investment decisions occurs within households, yet coordination problems between spouses can distort how risk is allocated. This study uses a lab-in-field experiment with married couples in rural Bangladesh to examine how partners coordinate risk-taking decisions under asymmetric information. In a sequential lottery-choice game, each household member chose a risky lottery from a common set, with total winnings equally shared between them. Only one in four subjects successfully coordinated their choice of lottery with their spouse's to achieve their intended household risk exposure. Most either took excessive risk or acted too conservatively due to biased beliefs about their partner's preferences. Men were 25% more likely than women to counter their spouse's choice, resulting in household portfolios more closely aligned with men's risk attitudes. Participants who mispredicted in the experiment also held biased beliefs about their spouse's real savings and asset holdings, highlighting how intrahousehold information frictions contribute to inefficient risk-sharing and distorted financial decisions.

WORKING PAPERS

Saha, K., Gulati, K., & Bird, S. “Agricultural Mechanization and Gendered Structural Transformation in India.”

Saha, K., Yadav, S, & **Saha, K.** “Gender Role Attitudes and Female Labor Participation: Evidence from Egypt”

Atallah, S., Dissanayake, S., Lopes, A.A., & **Saha, K.** “Indigenous Communities and Species Conservation – Examining the Role of Nature-Based Practices in Promoting Ecosystem Services.”

Saha, K., Lopes, A.A., & Tasneem, D. “Prickly Neighbors: Religion, Risk, and Human–Wildlife Coexistence.”

GRANTS

Jim and Neta Hicks Graduate Student Grant, Purdue University (USD 7,500), 2023.

AAEA Travel Grant 2025.

Purdue Graduate Student Government (PGSG) Travel Grant, 2024.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Agricultural & Applied Economics Association Annual Meeting. New Orleans, LA July 2024
“*Agricultural mechanization and gendered structural transformation in India.*”

Pacific Conference for Development Economics. Stanford University, Stanford, CA March 2024
“*Women’s Work and Agricultural Productivity Gaps in India*”

REFEREEING EXPERIENCE

Agricultural Economics, Review of Development Economics, International Social Science Journal

TEACHING

Teaching Assistant AGEC 217: Introductory Economics (Undergraduate) 2024

Teaching Assistant Econometrics I (Graduate) 2018

TECHNICAL & LANGUAGE SKILLS

Analytical STATA (Expert), R (Advanced), GAMS (Intermediate), Python (Intermediate), QGIS (Intermediate), Julia (Intermediate)

Survey SurveyCTO, Survey Solutions

Field Experience Bangladesh, India

Language English (Professional fluency), Bengali (Native), Hindi (Conversational)

REFERENCES

Dr. Kajal Gulati Assistant Professor, AFRE, Michigan State University
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Dr. Jacob Ricker-Gilbert Professor, Agricultural Economics, Purdue University
jrickerg@purdue.edu

Dr. Colin D. Sullivan Assistant Professor, Economics, University of Pittsburgh
colindsullivan@pitt.edu